SUPREME COURT
OF BRITISH COLUMBIA

Effective Date: March 31, 2026
Updated Date: October 1, 2026

Number: PD - 73

Title:

Practice Direction

Virtual Chambers (Associate Judges Chambers Pilot Project)

Summary:

The Associate Judges Chambers Pilot Project provides a means for parties to appear in virtual chambers in most registries. In virtual chambers all litigants appear by video by default, pursuant to *Supreme Court Civil Rule* 23.1-1(1) and (2) and *Supreme Court Family Rule* 22.1-1(1) and (2).

Direction:

Matters in scope

1. A party may schedule an application before an associate judge with a time estimate of 30 minutes or less in virtual chambers, except in proceedings filed in the Vancouver registry.

2. An electronic application record submitted in accordance with Practice Direction 72 – Electronic Application Records (Associate Judges Chambers Pilot Project) is required for an application scheduled in virtual chambers.

Scheduling applications in virtual chambers

3. Applications may be heard in virtual chambers, on a date on which the court hears applications (see https://www.bccourts.ca/supreme_court/practice_and_procedure/associate_judges_chambers_pilot_project.aspx).

4. To bring an application in virtual chambers, an applicant must serve a notice of intention to appear in virtual chambers, in the form attached as Appendix A, on parties and other persons who were served with the notice of application.

5. The notice of intention to appear in virtual chambers must be served at least 3 clear business days before the date on which the applicant files a notice of hearing of application scheduling the application on the virtual chambers list.

6. A person receiving a notice of intention to appear in virtual chambers may object to the application being heard in virtual chambers by notifying the applicant, in writing, of the objection, within 3 business days.

7. If no objection is received, the applicant may file a notice of hearing of application, in the form attached as Appendix B, setting down the application for hearing in virtual chambers. The application must otherwise be set down for hearing in regular chambers.

8. If a person who has received a notice of intention to appear in virtual chambers wishes to participate in the virtual chambers hearing, they must advise the applicant, in writing, that they wish to participate and serve and file an application response in accordance with the Supreme Court Rules.

Email link to Participate in Virtual Chambers

9. Prior to the virtual chambers hearing, the registry will e-mail the applicant to provide a link to participate in the application scheduled in virtual chambers by video.

10. Upon receipt, the applicant must forward the email received from the registry to all persons who have advised them that they wish to participate in the application scheduled in virtual chambers.

Check-in for virtual chambers

11. An applicant and any respondents must check-in at 9:15 a.m., using the Microsoft Teams link provided by the registry, on the day the application is scheduled.

12. Counsel and parties must comply with the technical and other requirements set out in Administrative Notice 18 - General Requirements for Microsoft Teams Video Hearings, and must observe the appropriate formality and decorum for a court proceeding.

13. Members of the public may listen to the hearing of an application on the virtual chambers list by calling 604-681-0260 and entering participant code 5862215.

Orders

14. Orders in Form 35 / Form F51, as applicable, must be modified as set out in Appendix C.

15. The process for having an order signed on the bench is as follows:

    a. A party should have the draft order vetted by the registry. A draft order may be vetted at the registry or through CSO by submitting the order with a requisition in Form 17 / Form F17, as applicable.

    b. The party must include a scanned and OCR'ed copy of the vetted order (if vetted at the registry), or the requisition and attached vetted order (if vetted through CSO), as part of the electronic application record.

c. At the same time that a party submits their electronic application record, they must also submit the vetted order (without an attached requisition) through the regular CSO eFiling service (not the Application Record service), specifying the virtual chambers hearing date.

d. The associate judge may, at their discretion, electronically sign the vetted order on the bench, if granted.

Resetting and adjourning applications in virtual chambers

16. To adjourn an application scheduled in virtual chambers, an applicant must file a requisition in the form attached as Appendix C.

17. To reset an application to the virtual chambers list, other than an application that has been adjourned generally, an applicant must file and serve a requisition in the form attached as Appendix C.

Ron A. Skolrood
Chief Justice

Appendix A

[Style of Proceeding]

NOTICE OF INTENTION TO APPEAR IN VIRTUAL CHAMBERS

Name(s) of applicant(s): .....

To: .....[*name(s) of party(ies) or person(s) affected*].....

TAKE NOTICE that the applicant intends schedule the application dated ……..[*date*]…… (the "Application") on the virtual chambers list at .....[*address of registry in which the proceeding is being conducted*]..... on a date to be set by Notice of Hearing of Application.

The applicant(s) estimate(s) that the Application will take .....[***max 30 minutes***]..... .

The applicant(s) propose(s) that the matter will be heard on ……[*insert date*]…… .

[x] This matter is within the jurisdiction of an associate judge.

APPLICANT'S EMAIL ADDRESS: ……..[*e-mail address*]……

TO THE PERSONS RECEIVING THIS NOTICE OF INTENTION TO APPEAR IN VIRTUAL CHAMBERS:
If you object to the Application being heard on the virtual chambers list you must notify the applicant, in writing, of your objection within 3 business days after service of this notice of intention to appear in virtual chambers.

If you wish to participate in the Application scheduled on the virtual chambers list you must advise the applicant, in writing, that you wish to participate in the Application and provide your email address to the applicant, if not already provided.

Please review Practice Directions 72 and 73, available at https://www.bccourts.ca/supreme_court/practice_and_procedure/associate_judges_chambers_pilot_project.aspx.

The public may listen to virtual chambers by dialing the following conference line: **604-681-0260** and entering participant code **5862215**.

Appendix B

FORM 33.01 (RULE 8-1 (14.4 (a))), F31.1 (RULE 10-6(13.4(a)))

[*Style of Proceeding*]

NOTICE OF HEARING OF APPLICATION

To: ..... [name(s) of application respondent(s), if any] ..... .

TAKE NOTICE that the notice of application of ..... [party(ies)] ..... dated ..... [date] ..... will be heard **on the virtual chambers list** at the courthouse at ..... [address] ..... on ..... [date] ..... at ..... [time of day] ..... .

APPLICANT'S EMAIL ADDRESS: .....[*e-mail address*].....

RESPONDENT(S)'S EMAIL ADDRESS(ES): .....[*e-mail address*].....

TO THE PERSONS RECEIVING THIS NOTICE OF HEARING OF APPLICATION:
Please review Practice Directions 72 and 73, available at
https://www.bccourts.ca/supreme_court/practice_and_procedure/associate_judges_chambers_pilot_project.aspx

1 Service

[*Check the correct box(es) and complete the required information.*]

[ ] The notice of application was served on ..... [date(s)] .....

[ ] The application response(s) was(were) served on ..... [date(s)] .....

[ ] No application response has been served and the time to serve a response has expired.

1.1 Proceeding on the virtual chambers list

[*Check the boxes to confirm and complete the required information.*]

[ ] The notice of intention to appear in virtual chambers was served on ..... [date(s)] .....

[ ] None of the persons on which the notice of intention to appear in virtual chambers was served on objected in writing to the application being heard in virtual chambers.

2 Date of hearing

[*Check whichever one of the following boxes is correct.*]

[ ] The parties have agreed as to the date of the hearing of the application.

[ ] The parties have been unable to agree as to the date of the hearing but notice of the hearing will be given to the application respondents in accordance with Rule 8-1 (14.5) of the *Supreme Court Civil Rules* / Rule 10-6 (13.5) of the *Supreme Court Family Rules*.

[ ] The application is unopposed, by consent or without notice.

3 Duration of hearing

[*Check the correct box(es) and complete the required information.*]

[ ] It has been agreed by the parties that the hearing will take ..... [time estimate] ..... .

[ ] The parties have been unable to agree as to how long the hearing will take and

a) the time estimate of the applicant(s) is ..... minutes, and
b) [ ] the time estimate of the application respondent(s) is ..... minutes.
[ ] the application respondent(s) has(ve) not given a time estimate.

4 Jurisdiction

[*Check whichever one of the following boxes is correct.*]

[**x**] This matter is within the jurisdiction of an associate judge.

[ ] This matter is not within the jurisdiction of an associate judge.

[ ] The application is a summary trial brought under Rule 9-7 of the *Supreme Court Civil Rules* / Rule 11-3 of the *Supreme Court Family Rules*.

[ ] The application is seeking a final order.

[ ] The application is seeking injunctive relief.

5 Orders sought

The orders being sought are as set out in the Notice of Application dated ..... [date] ..... : ..... [*set out paragraph numbers of orders from the Notice of Application and any additional proposed terms sought by consent*] ..... .

Date: .....

Signature of [ ] applicant [] lawyer for applicant(s)

..... [*type or print name*] ..... .

APPENDIX C

Form 17, F17

[*Style of Proceeding*]

REQUISITION – ASSOCIATE JUDGES CHAMBERS PILOT PROJECT

Filed by: .....[*party(ies)*].....

Required:

[*Select whichever one of the following provisions is correct, complete the selected provision and remove the provisions that have not been selected so that they do not appear in the form when the form is filed*.]

1. ☐ **Adjourn from virtual chambers list to regular chambers list:**

That the notice of application dated ……[*date*]…… and scheduled to be heard on the virtual chambers list at ……[*location*]…… on ……[*date*]……, be rescheduled to be heard at ……[*location*]…… on ……[*date*]…… at ……[*time*]……:

[*please check the appropriate box*]

☐ pursuant to the direction of associate judge ……[*name*]…… made on ……[*date*]……

☐ BY CONSENT

2. ☐ **Adjourn to new date on virtual chambers list:**

That the notice of application dated ……[*date*]…… and scheduled to be heard on the virtual chambers list at ……[*location*]…… on ……[*date*]……, be rescheduled to be heard on the virtual chambers list on ……[*date*]……:

[*please check the appropriate box*]

☐ pursuant to the direction of associate judge ……[*name*]…… made on ……[*date*]……

☐ BY CONSENT

3. ☐ **Adjourn generally:**

That the notice of application filed on ……[*date*]…… and scheduled to be heard on the virtual chambers list at ……[*location*]…… on ……[*date*]…… be adjourned generally, BY CONSENT.

4. ☐ **Adjourn from regular chambers list to virtual chambers list:** That the notice of application dated ……[*date*]…… and scheduled to be heard on at ……[*location*]…… on

……[*date*]…… at ……[*time*]……: be rescheduled to be heard on the virtual chambers list at ……[*location*]…… on ……[*date*]……:

[*please check the appropriate box*]

☐ pursuant to the direction of associate judge ……[*name*]…… made on ……[*date*]……

☐ BY CONSENT

[*please complete the information below*]

APPLICANT'S EMAIL ADDRESS: ……..[*e-mail address*]……

RESPONDENT(S)'S EMAIL ADDRESS(ES): ……..[*e-mail address*]……

This requisition is supported by the following:

Date: .....

Signature of [ ] applicant [] lawyer for applicant(s)

..... [*type or print name*] ..... .

Appendix D

Form 35, F51

[*Style of Cause*]

ORDER MADE AFTER APPLICATION

BEFORE } ASSOCIATE JUDGE _____ } DATE

[*Select whichever one of the following provisions is correct, complete the selected provision and remove the provisions that have not been selected so that they do not appear in the form when the form is filed*.]

ON THE APPLICATION of .....[*party(ies)*]..... coming on for hearing on the virtual chambers list at ..... on .....[*date*]..... and on hearing ..... [*name of party/lawyer*] ..... and .....[*name of party/lawyer*].....;

ON THE APPLICATION of .....[*party(ies)*]..... without notice coming on for hearing on the virtual chambers list at ..... on .....[*date*]..... and on hearing .....[*name of party/lawyer*].....;

THIS COURT ORDERS that:

[*If any of the following orders are by consent, indicate that fact by adding the words "By consent," to the beginning of the description of the order.]*

1.
2.
3.

THE FOLLOWING PARTIES APPROVE THE FORM OF THIS ORDER AND CONSENT TO EACH OF THE ORDERS, IF ANY, THAT ARE INDICATED ABOVE AS BEING BY CONSENT:

[*A signature line in the following form must be completed and signed by or for each approving party.*]

_____

Signature of [ ] party [ ] lawyer for .....[*name of party(ies)*].....
.....[*type or print name*].....

_____

Signature of [ ] party [ ] lawyer for .....[*name of party(ies)*].....
.....[*type or print name*].....

By the Court.

_____

Registrar